
Northbank case study

A review of the unsecured-loan refinance funnel — where it converts, where it leaks, and where next quarter's product effort should go.

Extract **31 August 2026**

Cohorts **Mar–Jun 2026, matured**

Base **40,000 offers**

For **MD & Head of Product**

Agenda

Three questions, answered in order — each with a one-line answer up front.

Q1

Refinance funnel review

Where it converts, where it leaks, and the verdict on both

Slides 03–11

Q2

Customer survey summary

Four moments where trust breaks, on a single slide

Slides 12–13

Q3

Next-quarter initiatives

Eight initiatives on impact vs effort, and why in that order

Slides 14–16

—

Caveats and method

What to trust, what to test, and every query behind it

Slide 17

Q1

QUESTION 1 OF 3

How is the refinance funnel working — which areas are doing well, and which could be improved?

THE ANSWER Strong once a customer engages — 93% convert past verification. The cost is upstream: 62% of offers are never opened, and one verification gate fails every single time.

Headline numbers

Funnel waterfall

Stage-by-stage leaks

Verdict

Five opportunities

The journey converts once a customer engages; the cost sits upstream

2.3% of offers become loans. The two biggest losses happen before the customer has filled in anything.

OFFER → LOAN

2.3%

909 loans from 40,000 offers

NEVER OPENED

62%

24,815 offers never viewed — the single largest leak

PUSH EFFECT

~2×

engagement lift at every stage, on top of email

£8.6M new loan balances written

£1.08M total-cost savings passed to customers

14.7% average APR on funded loans, avg. balance £9,509

Every stage that leaks maps to one of the five opportunities

40,000 offers in, 909 loans out. Stages 02 and 03 account for 37,082 of the 39,091 losses.

01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Offer sent	Viewed offer	Tapped apply	Requirements	Settlement upload	Verified	Loan funded
40,000	-24,815	-12,267	-1,143	-439	-358	909
Every eligible customer, 45% with a push.	62% never open the offer.	80.8% of viewers never apply.	39% stall on ID and income checks.	A median 9-day wait on the old lender.	All came from unsupported lenders.	92.9% of verified applicants convert.
	OPPORTUNITY 2	OPPORTUNITY 3	OPPORTUNITY 4	OPPORTUNITY 5	OPPORTUNITY 1	STRENGTH 2

Two of the seven steps account for 95% of all losses

■ Carried forward ■ Lost at this step

STAGE	SHARE OF ALL 40,000 OFFERS	LOST HERE	STEP CONV.
Offer sent		—	—
Viewed offer		-24,815	38.0%
Tapped apply		-12,267	19.2%
Requirements done		-1,143	60.8%
Settlement uploaded		-439	75.3%
Settlement verified		-358	73.2%
Loan funded		-69	92.9%

Everything from requirements onwards converts at 60–93%. The back half of the application is not the problem; the front of the journey is.

Three areas convert as intended; five need work

Ranked by addressable volume and how directly product can act; detail on slides 08–11.

Doing well

3 areas · protect these

- 01 Push roughly doubles engagement at every stage**
2.0× view, 2.0× apply, 1.9× loan — but only 45% of offers carry one
- 02 Past verification, the back half converts**
909 of 978 verified applicants fund — the strongest step in the funnel
- 03 Performance is steady, not decaying**
Offer-to-loan flat at 2.1–2.6% across four matured cohorts

Could be improved

5 opportunities, ranked

- 01 Settlement verification coverage** Slide 08
0% of the 358 applicants from unsupported lenders ever verify
- 02 Offer reach** Slide 09
62% never opened — 24,815 lost, more than all later stages combined
- 03 Offer value** Slide 10
View-to-apply 27.8% with a total-cost saving, 5.3% without
- 04 Application friction** Slide 11
39% never complete identity and income checks
- 05 Re-offer decay** Slide 11
Apply rate halves at every repeat — 13.6% down to 2.0%

Settlement verification works for 8 lenders and fails for every other

Of 1,336 applicants who uploaded a document, 978 came from a named lender and verified. All 358 from any other lender failed.

93%

verify → loan conversion where the document came from one of the **8 supported lenders** · 978 applicants

0%

ever pass verification where the document came from **any other lender** · 358 applicants, five matured cohorts

THE CAUSALITY CHECK

MARCH	APRIL	MAY	JUNE
230 = 230	271 = 271	241 = 241	236 = 236

Named-lender count equals verified count every month, so the lender name is populated *by* verification rather than being a condition *for* it. The ceiling is in the parsing pipeline, not the data.

RECOMMENDED ACTION

Scope as a platform investment, not a bug fix: wider document parsing, a manual-review fallback, or direct lender integrations. Size against ~358 applicants a quarter.

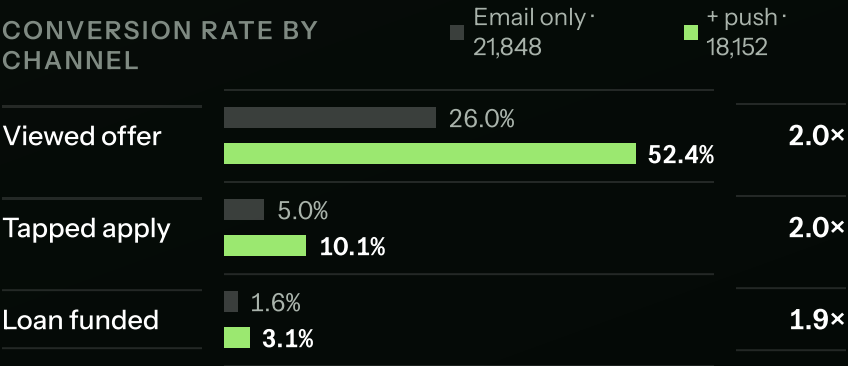
Reach is the largest single leak in the funnel

The notification is the impression and the offer view the click — except the audience is existing customers and there is no media spend.

WHERE THE 39,091 NON-CONVERTING OFFERS ARE LOST



■ Remaining 2,009 (5.1%) lost inside the application, across four stages



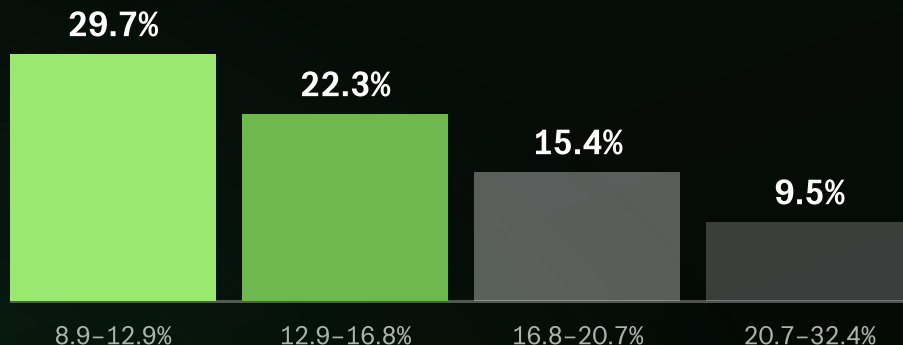
RECOMMENDED ACTION

Widen push eligibility; test in-app and SMS for email-only customers. Sequence after offer value — more reach into a weak offer only meets more disappointed customers.

View-to-apply falls as APR rises, and collapses without a total-cost saving

Only 19.2% of viewers tap apply. Offer economics, not visibility, predict who does.

VIEW → APPLY RATE BY OFFER APR QUARTILE



Offer APR, quartiles of all 40,000 offers · monotonic across all four

27.8%

view → apply when total cost falls

5.3%

view → apply when it does not

38.4% of offers cut the monthly payment without cutting total cost and **61.5%** extend the term to get there. Of viewers who do not apply first time, only **4.6%** ever apply on a re-offer — the value story has to land once.

TENSION TO WEIGH

Only 27.5% of highest-APR offers save anything today (avg - £887), so a blanket rule would exclude the highest-margin segment. A pricing call too.

Applicants stall on standard requirements, and every re-offer converts worse than the last

04 · A third stall inside the application

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

39%

never complete identity and income verification —
1,143 of 2,918 applicants

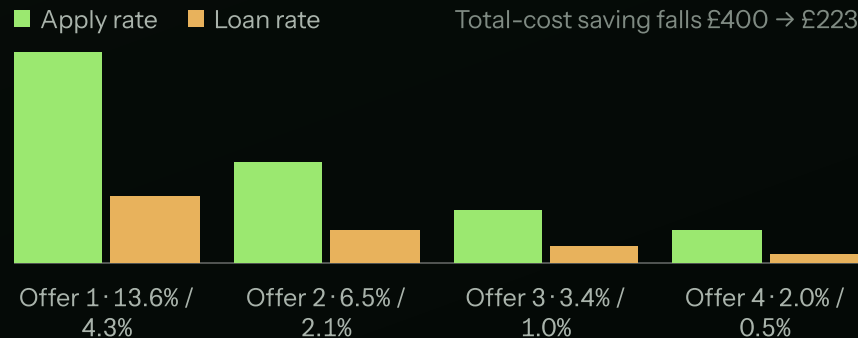
9 days

median wait from requirements to settlement upload,
spent waiting on the old lender

Customers reach requirements in 1–2 days, so the stall is effort, not patience. The settlement wait is a real external dependency worth chasing on the customer's behalf.

05 · Engagement halves at every re-offer

CHANNELS & ENGAGEMENT



Not only fatigue: the average total-cost saving *falls* across repeats while the monthly figure rises (£62 → £90) — a quietly worse deal, not the same one again.

 QUESTION 2 OF 3

Summarise the major findings from the customer survey for the product team, in one slide or less.

THE ANSWER Customers are not declining to refinance — they are declining to do it this way.

One slide

300 responses

Four moments

Customers are not declining to refinance; they are declining to do it this way

Four moments along one decision journey — the same three issues the funnel data shows, found independently.

STAGE 1 · WEIGHING IT UP

15%

They check the arithmetic themselves: a lower payment is not a saving if total cost rises.

"Lower monthly but a longer term. I worked out I'd pay about £600 more in the end."

STAGE 2 · DECIDING TO COMMIT

~7%

Before moving thousands of pounds, some want a person — reassurance self-serve cannot give.

"It's a big decision, I wanted a human not an app."

STAGE 3 · GETTING IT DONE

16%

A decision this size does not fit one sitting; momentum breaks and they do not return.

"Started the application but it was taking too long so I left it."

STAGE 4 · HANDING OFF CONTROL

15%

The one step outside our hands feels like being stranded, not in progress.

"Waiting on my lender for the settlement figure, it never came."

QUESTION 3 OF 3

List 5–10 initiatives to prioritise next quarter, and justify the ordering.

THE ANSWER Eight initiatives. Unblock the verification gate and put a floor under offer value first, then widen reach and cut friction, with test-and-learn running in parallel.

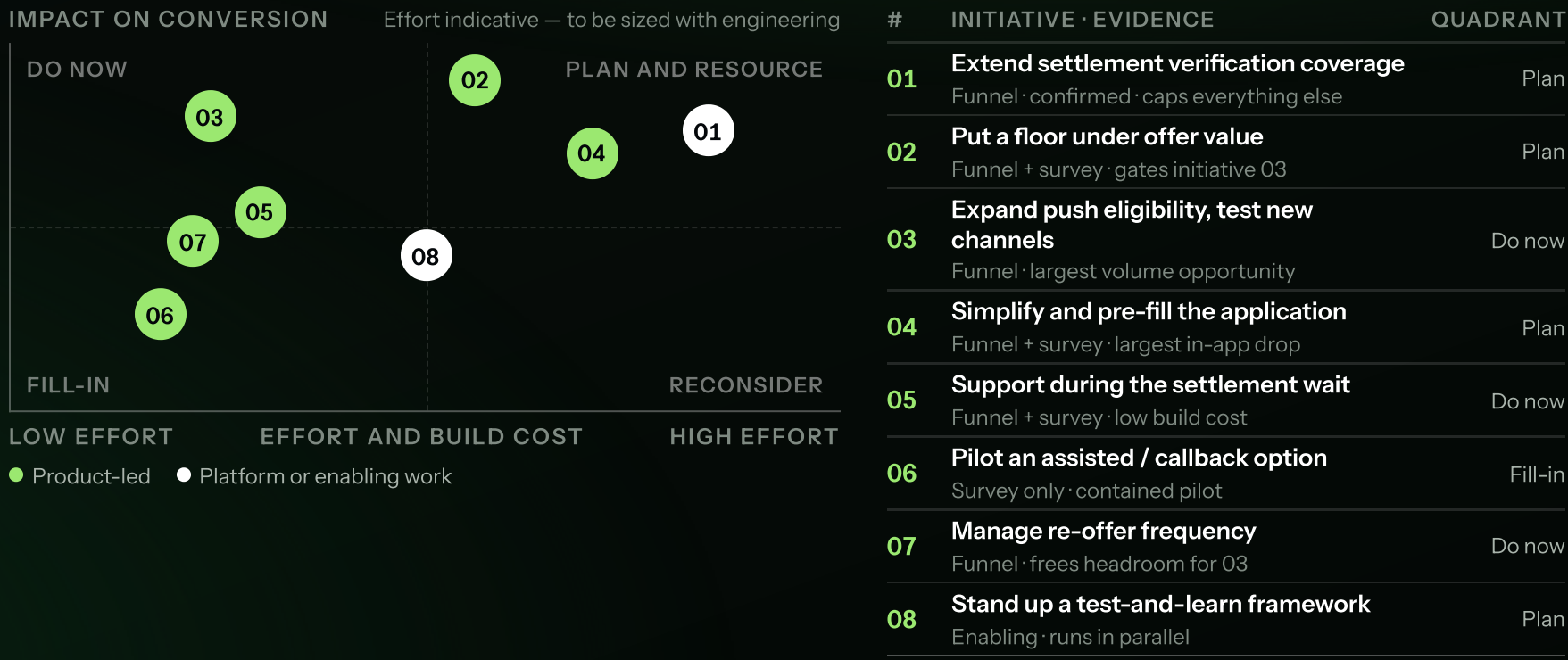
Eight initiatives

Impact vs effort

Assumptions to test

Example capabilities

Eight initiatives, ordered by what they unblock — not just by effort



Why this order — read down a column

	Offer value	Reach	Application friction	Verification coverage
WHAT CUSTOMERS FEEL From the survey	A longer term to get a lower payment — and more paid overall.	One email among many, with no second touchpoint.	Too long to finish in one sitting, so they leave it.	Stranded waiting on a figure from the old lender.
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS From the extract	View-to-apply 27.8% with a saving, 5.3% without. 38.4% of offers raise total cost.	62% never open. Push doubles engagement but reaches 45% of offers.	39% never complete ID and income checks. Median 9-day settlement wait.	0% of 358 applicants from unsupported lenders ever verify.
WHAT WE ARE ASSUMING And how we would test	Assumes the saving drives the uplift, not keener customers. Test: A/B a minimum-saving threshold.	Assumes the push lift is causal, not a proxy for app-engaged customers. Test: randomised push-eligibility A/B.	Assumes drop-off is effort, not eligibility. Test: pre-filled versus current requirements flow.	Confirmed, not assumed — named-lender count equals verified count every month. Nothing to test.
EXAMPLE CAPABILITY What we would need to build	Offer eligibility engine — saving thresholds and term caps as rules, not display copy.	Channel orchestration — push, SMS and in-app, with frequency control.	Save-and-resume — pre-filled data, status visibility, assisted route.	Document parsing — wider lender coverage behind a manual-review queue.

How to read this, and every query behind it

CAVEAT 1 Every offer in the extract was emailed, so email's own effect cannot be isolated — only push's incremental lift on top of it.

CAVEAT 2 APR, saving and push comparisons are correlational — consistent enough to act on, but A/B tests would confirm causality before rollout.

CAVEAT 3 Opportunity 1 is the exception — causally confirmed. Extending coverage is a platform decision, not a product lever.

Deliberately not published: estimating each customer's current APR from balance, payment and term. Not cleanly comparable with the fields available, so it was dropped rather than forced.

QUERY INVENTORY · DUCKDB

Data setup & integrity	2
Core funnel	2
Channels & engagement	5
Proposition	5
Digital experience	2
Lender-verification investigation	6
Business impact	1
Survey theme coding	2

funnel.csv, quotes.csv and survey.csv joined 1:1 on application_id.
Full query text in the written review.